Proud to be a Blerd

By Omar Holman and Daniel Beaty

Trigger Warning: *Contains the "N" word referring to Black men*

INTRODUCTION

The word "blerd" was coined in the late 1990s; meaning the experience of growing up as a Black person who has nerdy interests. The first signs of popularity began with Steve Urkel, an obnoxious and nerdy character on the show "Family Matters." With every . . . "Did I do that?" Urkel made his way into the hearts of viewers; and more importantly, he validated the feelings of Black nerds just like him.

Today, with various online communities and groups, the 'nerd' segment of the Black population can easily find kindred spirits while staying true to their identity. We are more than just "athletic." We are not all "thugs," gang members or criminals. We are unique and today Black creativity is celebrated and embraced.

Proud to be a Blerd with poems by Omar Holman and Daniel Beaty

10 Things I Want to Say to a Black Nerd by Omar Holman (Pg 93-96)

After Jenifer Falu's "10 Things I want to say to a Black Man"

1 - It's so hard being a Black nerd

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2 - The books you love

don't have many heroes or villains that look like you

It's not the color but the content of

the characters that keep you reading

3 - You thank God for Donald Glover

and his songs as Childish Gambino

Listening to him is the like having Nikola Tesla sitting

shotgun in The Delorean

while doing Pi …sorry, "donuts" in a Game Stop

parking lot, top down as Tesla says,

"Is that the new Afrofuturism mixtape?

Homie, TURN. THAT. SHIT. UP!"

4 - Batman's superpower

is generational wealth and stock options.

That has nothing to do with the rest of the poem,

I just felt it really needed to be said

5 - There is nothing more beautiful than a Black nerd girl

Any time you hear 'em rep their fandoms,

you Dance Dance Revolutions round your heart

If she has natural hair

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and wants to converse about Converse?

+10 damage points

Talks trash whenever she beats you in Mario Kart?

+25 skill points

If she watches Craig of Creek

and writes her own fan fiction,

there's, no calculation for how sexy that is

6 - When you get the girl,

you'll remember every detail,

like how the paint on her nails

chips into isolated islands

When you get the boy, you'll reminisce

on how he made oblivious look like the new abstinence

When you have each other,

you'll recall the memory as an 8-bit adventure;

call it old-school, call it classic,

whatever symbolizes

that the moment was an arcade high score

you both achieved together

7 - Your most hood moment on Game of Thrones

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when they killed Ned Stark

Even as I mention it now,

inside you're saying to yourself,

"They killed my n****a Ned Man"

They killed my ni***a Ned!"

For nerds, Ned Stark's death is equivalent to

when Hip-Hop heads lost Biggie Smalls

or when Friends went off the air for white people

8 - Your black friends say

hand over your black card

because you never watched "The Wire"

Your white friends think,

having watched "The Wire,"

it's okay for them to say

they're "blacker" than you are

since nerd is the new Black,

so, "Everybody wanna be a nerd

but don't nobody ***wanna*** be a nerd"

9 - A nerd-off is the closest you will ever come

to battle rap

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It occurs whenever someone

corrects you on a topic obnoxiously

If you engage in this Battle Royale of facts,

your retort should always sound something like this:

“Actually, Blade is the movie that kick-started all these

other superhero movies …”

and once you see that look of

“Oh they ‘bout murder me” on their face,

you Highlander them with a stare that says,

“You goin’ get this work,

cause I’m a Grayskull graduate

with a Masters in the Universe

and you ain’t ‘bout this life, B”

10 - It is so hard being a Black nerd,

slinging six-sided-dice on the block,

keeping it retro

when you pop out the Nintendo 64

like it’s an Impala,

all Black everything

because that’s what you’ve always been …

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everything.

From

Chuck Taylors to lightsabers

From

“Press Start” to “Game Over”

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Omar Holman
Book: We Were All Someone Else Yesterday, Pgs 93-96
ISBN: 978-1943735686
Publisher: Button Poetry
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I am Nerd by Omar Holman

I heard they want to abolish the “n” word

but I am the “n” word,

the "n" word is me,

I am that nerd.

I am that nerd that “cool” passed up in high school.

Left standing against the walls at school dances,

snapping my fingers to the music,

asking ladies "Dance?

No, okay that's cool. Dance?

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Hell no, okay that's cool. I'm still good."

I am that nerd,
that never scored the winning touchdown for the team
but was an English class MVP.
Report cards looking like Duracell batteries, triple A's.
Standing on top of my desk,
with a one hundred percent on my test,
yelling out "Who want it with me?"
I'm Oscar Wildin' Out, Rob. You can't defrost me.
I'm stone cold Jane Austin out this b****.

I am that nerd,
it was I who was online 25 days, 4 hours, and 5 minutes.
Yes, it was I who stood in line waiting 18 hours for Halo 3.
If Carrie Underwood were dating me,
there would be no car for her to key.
She'd have to sing while scratching my Xbox 360,
taking a Louisville slugger to both controllers,
while singing . . .
"Next time, he'll maybe think twice before he uses a cheat code on me."

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Yes, that nerd is me.
Therefore, I'm entitled to be that geek with the vast knowledge of
Mangas, Animes, and comic books;
since these are the foundations of our culture.
Thus in the name of Harry Potter, Goku, Optimus Prime, He Man, Sailor Moon . . .
(chanting/singing) *Thunder, Thunder, Thunder, Thunder Cats -- Hoooo!

But once 12 o'clock came, it was all over when you heard Soul Train.
You remember me from 2nd period chemistry.
I'm that geek with no need for using a third eye;
I'm equipped with four eyes.
The pocket protector stays strapped, what you need?
Ruler, pen, calculator, I got that.

So, know that it is me who rocks
different super hero shirts for everyday of the week.
Yes, it is I who's obsessed with Green Lantern and The Space Police.

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We harass Jedis, while pulling over Autobots and
Decepticons
Because this is training day in outer space and
Voltron ain't got sh** on me.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Omar Holman
On-line Transcript:
https://destinyspoetrymovements.weebly.com/slam.html
Date (Month/Year): Performance at NYC-Urbana 2010
Finals at the Bowery Poetry Club, May 2010
Access video at:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FP2gDoZPeOI&t=1s

Duality Duel by Daniel Beaty

There's a battle going on inside of me
Between my well-crafted external persona
and an internal force trying to break free.
It's a battle you see, between the nerd,
and the n****r in me.
Can the nerd and the n*** a coexist?
They 'gon have to nerd
But Ni***!-
It doesn't make sense.
I didn't spend four years in the Ivy League,

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learning how to think, talk, and feel,
in order to jump into a rage every time they try and kill me.
But the truth is Nerd, I've always been around: When that Poison Ivy bullsh*t was beating you down, these strong arms, they held you: told you not to feel it.
Gave you time enough to heal it and become a Nerd again.

But N***a!
All you seem to feel is rage and that will keep me out of their circles and off the front page of the New York Times and the Daily News.
Not if you shoot a *man.*
And that's my point. You are more than that cold stony glare, those weighty Timberlands and that nappy hair.
Aw hold up now!
No N***a! That rage is like a cage that keeps love out and you in jail.

Aww shut up Nerd! You ain't heard a word I said. I gotta smack you upside yo well-brushed head? Without me there is no you.

No wait a minute N***a, let's talk this through.

Naw Nerd! Journey to the n***a in you. I've been inside long enough, I got ya through school, gave you time enough to learn their rules. Now the time has come to pay your dues.

Cuz these little n****s in the street, they need you.

But they think they can't relate cuz you act all removed.

When the truth is Nerd; what they are is you.

Cuz no matter how hard you try to deny the way you think, talk, and feel, ghetto nightmares still haunt your dreams, and your Mamma is still black.

I ain't saying you gotta become me, but this one thing is true;

inside you is a harda** n***a, you gotta let him come through.

Cuz this assimilating bullsh*t will surely beat you down.

You choke me long enough, I will not stick around.

Put the strut back in your walk. Say what you really feel.

Be all of you, so all of us can heal.

The time for lying and denying is through.

It's time Nerd,

journey to the N***a in you.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Daniel Beaty
Book: Transforming Pain to Power: Unlock Your Unlimited Potential
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Found on-line at https://www.answers.com/music-and-radio/What_are_the_lyrics_to_Duality_Duel_by_Daniel_Beaty

AWARD HISTORY

2019 National Qualifier – as a collection

**Theme from ThunderCats can be found here:*
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Na8ThDftsKk&t=1s

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